

LOWER WYBURNS

Six copy-ready planning objections for residents
Application 26/00538/FUL - 94 homes, Daws Heath Road, Rayleigh

HOW TO SEND YOUR OBJECTION

Rochford application: 26/00538/FUL **Planning Portal reference:** PP-14920918

Online: www.rochford.gov.uk/comment-on-an-application - open the online planning system, complete the application and choose **Submit comments**.

Email: planning.applications@rochford.gov.uk - put **26/00538/FUL - Lower Wyburns** in the subject line and include your name and address.

How to use this: You do not need to use all six points. Pick the ones you agree with and, if possible, add one or two sentences about your own experience - for example flooding you have seen, using Daws Heath Road, wildlife you have observed, or photographs you hold. You can copy the wording below directly or adapt it into your own words.

1. GREEN BELT

Relevant NPPF: GB6, GB7 and Annex E

I object because this is currently Green Belt land and much of the proposed housing would be built across open paddocks at the edge of Rayleigh. Building 94 homes here would permanently change the open character of the land and extend the built-up area further out. Bellway says the land should be treated as grey belt, but I do not believe it has shown convincingly that the actual open land proposed for housing meets that test. A recent Planning Inspector also found that nearby open land on Daws Heath Road strongly helped to prevent the outward spread of Rayleigh. If the Council approves this development, it should be able to explain clearly why this open Green Belt land meets the national tests and why building here would not add to the sprawl of Rayleigh.

2. HIGHWAYS, DAWS HEATH ROAD & THE A127

Relevant NPPF: TR3, TR4 and TR6

I object because Daws Heath Road is narrow and constrained towards the A127. Bellway's own report says parts are about 4.3 metres wide and records very limited visibility at the tight bend near the A127. The road then joins directly onto the 50mph A127. I am also concerned that Bellway has assumed very little extra development traffic will use this junction and has not included the Daws Heath Road/A127 junction in its detailed junction-capacity modelling. The effect of traffic from 94 homes and construction HGVs on the whole route, the bend and the A127 junction needs proper consideration. If permission is granted, the Council and Highway Authority should be able to explain clearly why they consider this route and junction safe for the extra traffic and why Bellway's traffic assumptions can be relied upon.

3. FLOODING, DRAINAGE & EASTWOOD BROOK

Relevant NPPF: F7 and F8

I object because Eastwood Brook is a Main River, part of the northern land is in Flood Zones 2 and 3, and this area has a history of flooding. Bellway proposes to control surface water and discharge it towards Eastwood Brook, but the drainage system also needs to work during extreme rainfall and when the Brook is already high. The Council should take local flood records, photographs and previous flood-alleviation work in this area seriously and consider whether the development could increase flood risk elsewhere. If permission is granted, the Council should be able to show clearly that the drainage system will work in difficult conditions and that the development will not make flooding worse for neighbouring or downstream areas.

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Six copy-ready planning objections - continued

4. ECOLOGY & LANDSCAPE

Relevant NPPF: N2

I object because the site contains woodland, native hedgerows and connected wildlife habitat, and Bellway's own ecology work says some internal hedgerows would be lost. Bellway's report also says further surveys were being carried out for bats, dormice, reptiles, great crested newts and birds. All necessary wildlife evidence should be available before the application is decided, and the results should actually shape the final layout, lighting, drainage and landscaping if changes are needed. If permission is granted, the Council should be able to show that it had the necessary wildlife evidence before making its decision and that important habitat and protected species have been properly dealt with.

5. HERITAGE, HISTORIC BOUNDARY & ARCHAEOLOGY

Relevant NPPF: HE5

I object because this area contains important features of the historic landscape, including the old Lower Wyburns farmstead, historic routes and boundaries, surviving earthworks, and the raised bank and hedge marking the historic Thundersley boundary. Bellway's proposed road works may affect this historic boundary. The Council should establish the age, importance and exact extent of the bank and hedge, whether the hedge meets the legal criteria for an important historic hedgerow, and exactly what the proposed works would remove or damage. The wider archaeological evidence should also be properly considered before irreversible work is approved. If permission is granted, the Council should be able to explain why it was satisfied that these historic features had been properly understood and protected as far as reasonably possible.

6. SUSTAINABILITY & LOCAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Relevant NPPF: GB7, GB8, TR3 and TR6

I object because I am not convinced this is a genuinely sustainable location for 94 homes. Bellway's own figures put Rayleigh station about 2.2km away - around a 29-minute walk - and the scheme provides 201 parking spaces, which suggests substantial car use is expected. The development also needs new foul-water pumping and other infrastructure. The Council should consider whether future residents will have a realistic choice other than regular car use and whether roads, drainage, utilities, schools, health services and other necessary infrastructure can be properly provided. If permission is granted, the Council should be able to explain clearly why it considers the location sustainable and show that the necessary infrastructure and improvements are deliverable and properly secured.

FINAL TIP: A short objection with one or two clear planning reasons and your own local evidence can be more useful than a long copied letter. Keep it factual and avoid house prices, loss of a private view or rumours.